



U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE)
Detainee Death Report: GARCIA Hernandez, Jairo

Immigration and Criminal History

Mr. Jairo GARCIA Hernandez, a 27-year-old male citizen of Guatemala, was arrested by U.S. Border Patrol in Irondequoit, NY, on January 21, 2025, and detained by ICE at the Buffalo Federal Detention Facility in Batavia, NY. On September 7, 2025, ICE Enforcement and Removal Operations (ERO) Buffalo transferred him to ERO Miami for detention at Larkin Community Hospital Behavioral Health Center in Hollywood, FL, and subsequently to Krome Service Processing Center in Miami, FL. On September 23, 2025, ERO Miami transferred Mr. GARCIA Hernandez to ERO El Paso for detention at El Paso Behavioral Health System in El Paso, TX. On October 18, 2025, ERO El Paso returned him to ERO Miami for detention at Krome Service Processing Center in Miami, FL.

His criminal history includes an arrest in Watkins Glen, NY, on October 31, 2023, for several charges. He was convicted of criminal possession of a weapon and sentenced to time served on May 23, 2024.

Synopsis of Events

Upon admission to ICE custody on January 21, 2025, Mr. GARCIA Hernandez underwent a medical intake screening, which documented his history of anxiety, infectious diseases, and prior injuries. He was referred to medical and behavioral health providers for further evaluation and cleared for custody.

Over the following months, Mr. GARCIA Hernandez received comprehensive medical and mental health assessments, including treatment for disease, viral infection, and anxiety. He was monitored for chronic health conditions, and his medications were adjusted as needed. Behavioral health staff regularly evaluated him for symptoms of depression, anxiety, and suicidal ideation. He was placed on suicide watch multiple times due to reported suicidal thoughts and self-harm behaviors.

Mr. GARCIA Hernandez was transferred between several facilities for specialized mental health and medical care, including inpatient psychiatric treatment and management of kidney failure, heart failure, and infections. He underwent dialysis and received ongoing care for his complex medical needs, including infectious disease management, heart failure, and renal failure.

Throughout his time in custody, Mr. GARCIA Hernandez experienced periods of mental health deterioration, medication noncompliance, and repeated hospitalizations for medical emergencies. Despite ongoing medical and psychiatric interventions, his condition continued to worsen.

On January 26, 2026, a registered nurse evaluated Mr. Hernandez after he reported feeling unwell, noting a fever and elevated pulse. COVID-19 and influenza tests were negative, and he was sent to Larkin Community Hospital South (LCHS) Emergency Room.



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From January 27 to February 9, LCHS staff diagnosed Mr. Hernandez with pulmonary edema, possible infection, hemoptysis, and severe anemia. He received blood transfusions and specialist consultations. Between February 10 and 13, he was diagnosed with endocarditis and sepsis and received treatment.

On February 14, Mr. Hernandez refused vital signs, oxygen, blood draws, and dialysis. On February 16, nursing staff found Mr. Hernandez unresponsive and initiated life-saving measures for 24 minutes, but he remained pulseless. He was pronounced deceased at 2:01 a.m.